boing

DIAGNOSTIC WORKBOOK

Before the logo.

20 questions to find out whether your brand has a solid strategic foundation.



Think before you design.

A practical tool for founders and teams at small brands. It doesn't replace market research or a professional audit.

How to use this *workbook*



Set aside 25 to 40 minutes. Answer with concrete examples and flag what is still a hypothesis.

01 Answer

Write specific answers. Avoid phrases like "for everyone" or "quality and innovation".

02 Identify the evidence

Separate what you know from data, interviews or observation from what you assume.

03 Set priorities

At the end, choose up to three questions to investigate before investing in branding.

METHODOLOGY NOTE

This is an exploratory diagnosis, not a scientifically validated test. The questions reveal gaps and hypotheses, but they can't measure the "quality" of a brand.

PART 01 OF 05

The problem you *solve*

Before you sell a solution, you need to understand the need.

01 What specific problem leads someone to look for your brand?

02 What changes in the customer's life after using your product or service?

03 What alternatives do they use today to meet that need, including not buying at all?

04 What evidence do you have that this need is relevant and frequent?

EXAMPLE · 9AM CLUB

At 9AM Club, the hypothesis grew from "I want to do Pilates" to include the search for recurring social routines.

PART 02 OF 05

The people you want to *reach*

An audience isn't defined only by age or location.

01 Who feels the problem most intensely, and in what context?

02 What situation or event triggers the search for a solution?

03 What fears or obstacles could stop the first purchase?

04 What sets your primary audience apart from secondary segments?

EXAMPLE · 9AM CLUB

We created two proto-personas: Sofia, new to Madrid, and Lucía, a local. Their reasons for joining the club are different.

PART 03 OF 05

Your *differentiation*

Being different isn't enough; you need to be relevant.

01 Which real alternatives will the customer compare before choosing?

02 Why would they choose your brand if another offered something similar?

03 What promise can you keep and credibly prove?

04 What would be hard for a competitor to copy: experience, method or relationship?

EXAMPLE · 9AM CLUB

The conceptual difference wasn't "Pilates with coffee", but recurring meetups and an experience that builds familiarity.

PART 04 OF 05

The experience you *offer*

A brand is also what happens after the click.

01 How does someone feel at their first contact with your brand?

02 Which moments of the journey create friction, doubt or insecurity?

03 What behaviours or rituals would make people come back on their own?

04 Does the experience you deliver match the promise in your communication?

EXAMPLE · 9AM CLUB

The 9AM Circles were designed as recurring class groups, with optional time together after the workout.

PART 05 OF 05

Identity and *communication*



Design should make the strategy visible and usable.

01 Which three ideas do you want people to associate with your brand?

02 If you remove the logo, what makes your communication recognisable?

03 Are your visual and verbal choices consistent with your positioning?

04 What proof or message is missing to help the customer decide?

EXAMPLE · 9AM CLUB

In the 9AM Club concept, the editorial lettering, colours and photography were chosen to express a contemporary social club.

The diagnosis *matrix*

Rate each dimension and note what evidence is missing.

0 no clear answer 1 weakly supported hypothesis 2 well-founded answer

The problem you solve

0 1 2

What evidence is missing?

The people you want to reach

0 1 2

What evidence is missing?

Your differentiation

0 1 2

What evidence is missing?

The experience you offer

0 1 2

What evidence is missing?

Identity and communication

0 1 2

What evidence is missing?

Don't add up the points to create a brand "score". Use your answers to see where you need to learn more: research, strategic clarity or a review of the experience.

Action *plan*

Choose three priority gaps and turn them into concrete next steps.

PRIORITY 01

What do we need to clarify?

How will we get evidence?

Who is responsible, and by when?

PRIORITY 02

What do we need to clarify?

How will we get evidence?

Who is responsible, and by when?

PRIORITY 03

What do we need to clarify?

How will we get evidence?

Who is responsible, and by when?

And after the *diagnosis*?

Better questions are the first step. The next one is turning them into brand choices.

If you found doubts about positioning, audience, experience or identity, don't automatically start with the logo. Define your hypotheses, look for evidence and choose what should come first.

boing. *boost*

Strategy, visual identity and creative direction for brands that want to build a recognisable, relevant foundation.

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9AM Club is a conceptual project developed by boing. The examples illustrate strategic hypotheses, not validated market results.